



TEAM

INTRO

"Jordan with Forty-Three. Malone is doubled, they swat at it and steal it. Here comes Chicago, 17 Seconds. 17 seconds from game 7 or from championship game number 6. Jordan.... Open.... CHICAGO WITH THE LEAD! Time out Utah. 5.2 seconds left. Michael Jordan, running on fumes with 45 points. At the end of the game, you got to get it out of his hands. He's beat you so many times. You watch Jordan play, Doug, and you know at the end of the game he's a killer. This was really the play that hurt Isaiah because they scored so quickly. Michael got in there and scored within 4 seconds. And what... and what happened was, Michael doubled back. You're gonna see he's in the play. Look where Hornacek is setting the screen. Michael never clears, so Malone doesn't seem him. He comes from the blindside and strips him. So, 3 crucial plays by Michael Jordan now. As he gets Bryan Russel with a quick crossover. Bryan Russel slips, and Michael pulls up to bury the shot to give them a 1-point lead. That may have been, who knows within the next several months, but that may have been the last shot Michael Jordan will ever take in the NBA."

This game will echo through the ages as one of the greatest games ever played. Jordan continued to play in the NBA until April of 2003, but the 1996 Chicago Bulls will go down in history as one of the best athletic teams to play the game. It was a battle till the very end, between two militias of basketball. Stories of Michael Jordan and his unstoppable team will be told for generations to come. The cohesive abilities they maintained as a team will forever stand as a standard of a successful team. But that begs the question: what makes a successful team successful? Teams that are built upon the pillars of adaptability, responsibility, accountability, leadership, communication, and consistency is what makes them successful.



COMMUNICATION
TRUST
ADAPTABILITY
PURPOSE
ACCOUNTABILITY
CONSISTENCY
RESPONSIBILITY
LEADERSHIP

ADAPTABILITY

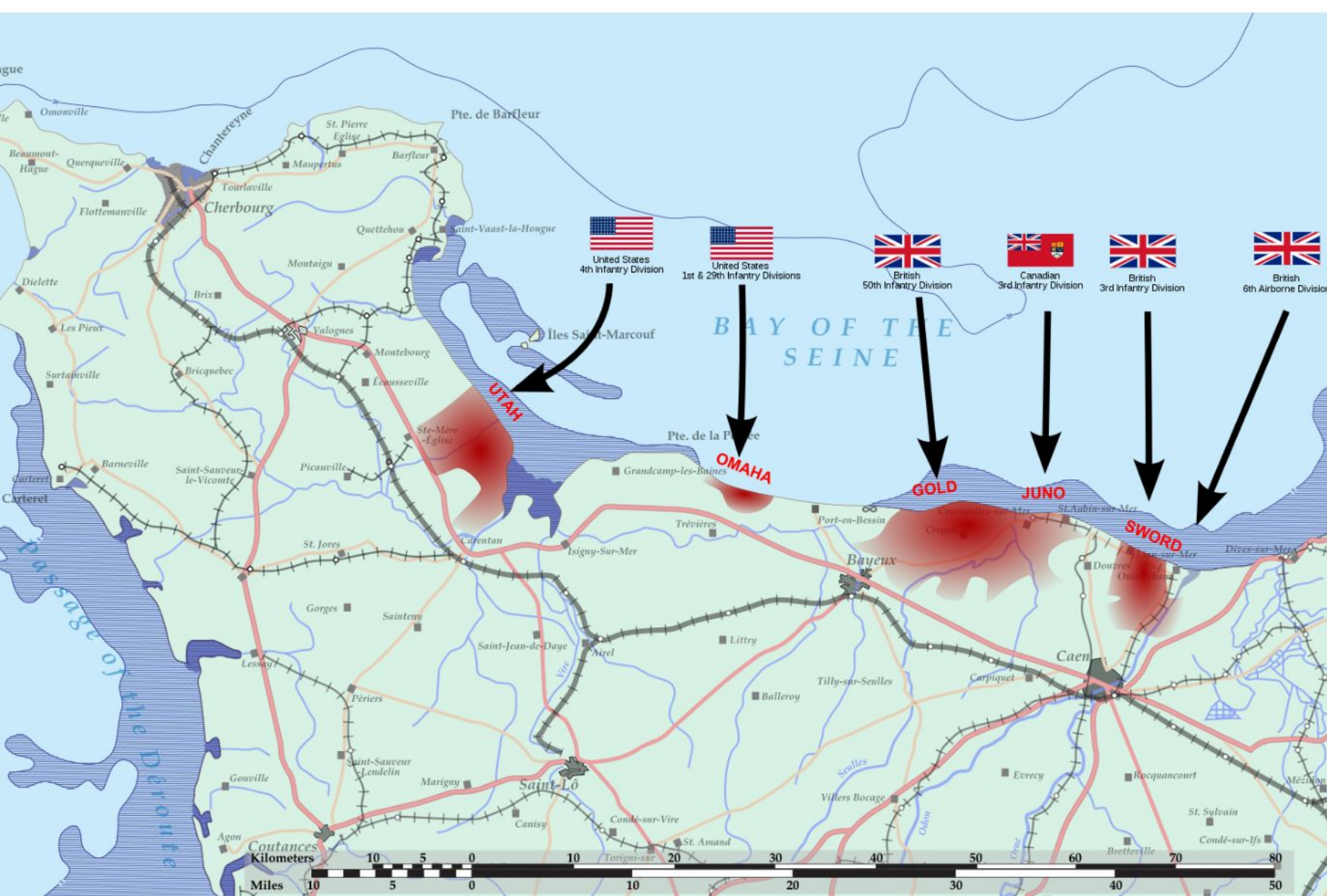
There is a common saying amongst those who are a part of the military. It goes to say that “even the best plan changes as soon as the first bullet goes flying.” Or in civilian terms, that every plan has a counter plan or force that acts against it, therefore the plan must change to counteract the force that opposes it. To put it simply, it translates to the word adaptability. Every team knows that adaptability is a key to success in whatever endeavor you may encounter. Being able to change your environment to be able to survive rather than force your will upon the environment is important for your personal growth and the growth of your team.





D-Day as the world knows it today is a perfect example of men making instinct changes to become adaptable to the environment they were in. Germany almost had all of Europe in its grasp and had already started its spread to other fronts. June 6th, 1944 was a day which changed the world. American, Canadian, and British soldiers together infiltrated the German infested beaches of Normandy. The allies were met with a force so daunting that it seemed as though their plan was hopeless. During the first waves of the invasion, approximately 15,000 men had landed on Normandy and half of them had mowed down German gun fire, but thousands more kept coming.





The allied forces were not ready to give up the fight. With heavy suppressive machine gun fire coming their way, they made split-second decisions that allowed them to achieve their objective. Brigadier General Norman Cota made one of those split-second decisions. He found a handful of Army Rangers taking cover behind a sand bank. In a commanding voice he yelled "Get up and Lead the Way!" With a renewed drive to win the fight, they were able to destroy barbed wire fencing and barricades and cleared paths for soldiers to invade the German stronghold. Many other leaders had rallied other troops through that hellish day and penetrated German forces. Quickly, all 5 objectives including Omaha and Utah beaches had been captured by ally forces. Although the victory was great it came with many casualties. Many of the men had to make hard, life and death decisions. Gratefully, their clutch ability to be adaptable made the difference for them and they were able to change the course of the war. If they had not adapted to their environment, WW2 may not have ended the way it did (Flemming, 1994).





There are many other examples of adaptability. Seal team 6 when they invaded Osama Bin Laden's compound and were able to assassinate their objective and evacuate although one of their choppers went down. (Owen, 2016) Sometimes even though we are adaptable, it doesn't mean we always come out on top. This means being in a tough environment but being able to come out and do your job no matter the consequences. Adaptability can be seen in many different teams. It is key to be adaptable when participating in a group or team. Adaptability can be the difference between win or lose, and sometimes life and death.

RESPONSIBILITY



Michael Jordan and the 1996 Chicago Bulls are a great example of what it means to know your role and your responsibility. Each team member on and off the court knew how they could contribute to the success of the team. This allowed the team to not only be able to overcome their opponents, but to trust one another and that they knew that their teammates would get their job done. It is evident that this team was so successful in knowing their roles and responsibilities since they won 6 NBA championships.

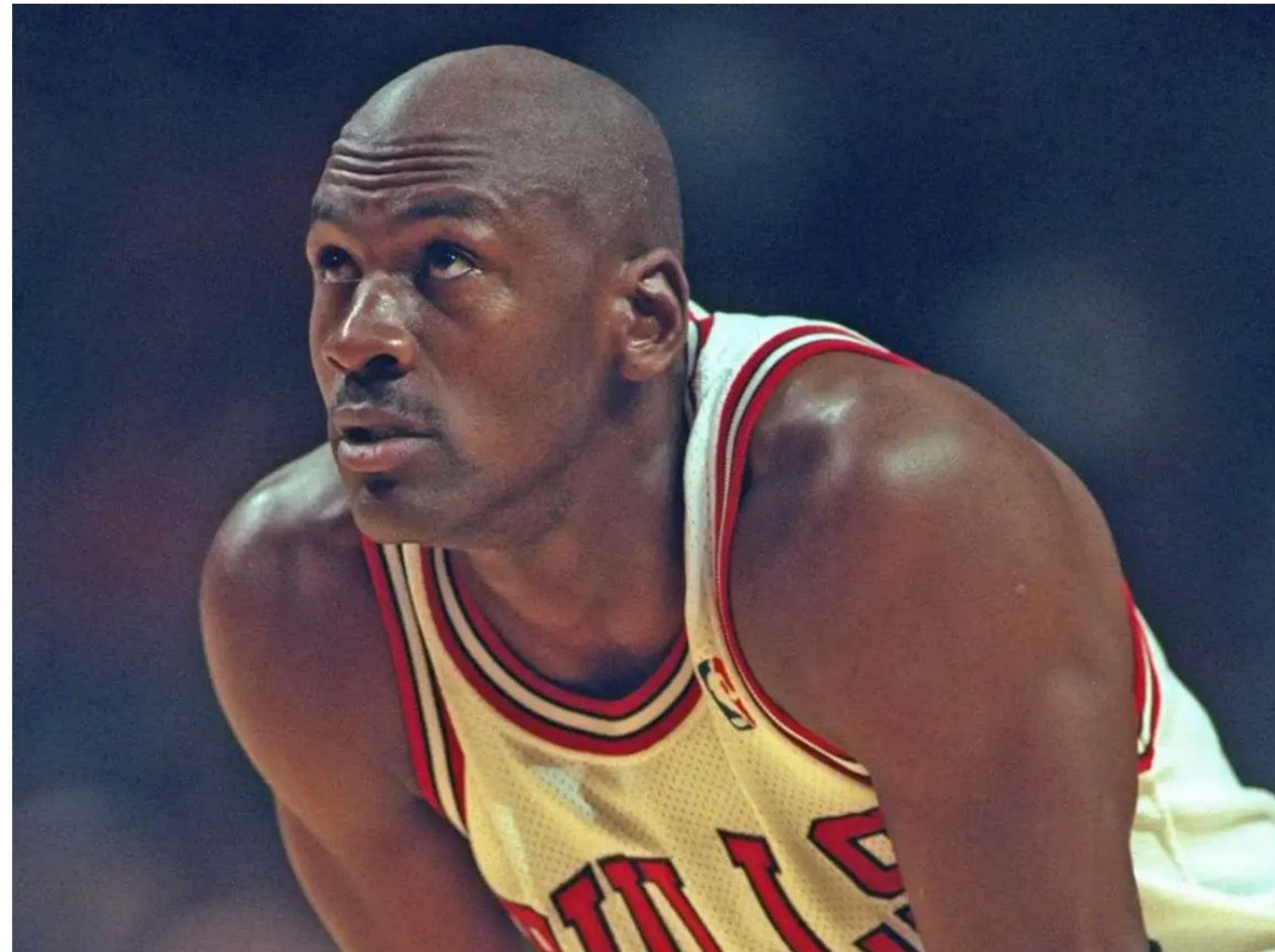
On a team everyone does not have the same job. Each person's individual role is important to the team. Being able to do your job well, as well as work well with others is what makes you a good team player. "Teams work together and teams fail together" there are no "scapegoats" (University of the People, 2020). Accepting consequences for your actions and being able to do your job and no matter the consequences make you a stronger team player. Responsibility is an attribute that many successful teams maintain. Granted, responsibility can take time to build in oneself. However, when everyone on a team takes responsibility for their role, and their actions, it makes the team stronger overall.





Scottie Pippen, was a solid asset to the team because of his well-rounded ability to play the game. The bulls knew that they could count on Pippin in a moment of need. They knew that he would always fulfill his role and responsibility. Dennis Rodman was a great defensive player and would always rebound the ball to allow his team more opportunities to get a basket. Despite his crazy hairdos, he was a brick wall that was hard to get over.

Michael Jordan was the game changer. He could see and understand the court better than the whole team. He could make plays come alive from any bad or difficult circumstance that he or his team found themselves in. "Great teams do not wait for the leader to remind members when they are not pulling their weight, because there is no lack of clarity about what they have committed to do, they are comfortable calling one another on actions and behaviors that don't contribute to the likelihood of success" (Compton, 2007). While Micheal Jordan was one of the best basketball players to ever live, Jordan knew that he needed his whole team; Harper, Longley, and Wennington included. They knew that if they worked together and fulfilled their roles, nothing could stand in their way from getting their championship. That team cohesiveness and understanding of responsibilities did result in the championship win.





ACCOUNTABILITY



Rugby is an international sport that is played by some of the best athletes in the world. Part of the reason that makes these athletes so great is that they are willing to accept accountability for their actions. Like many other sports this game has consequences for fouls and violations of the game. When a player receives a violation card, the referee explains to the person the reason they received that card. In many sports we see the players argue back and fight the decision that was made by the referee because they thought that they were in the right. Many times, the referee receives a reprimand when they are trying to help keep each team safe. In rugby the players very rarely fight back against the referee. In fact, it is the exact opposite. Often you will see a professional rugby player thank the referee for his feedback and the consequence they received for the action they took. "Accountability is understood as an implicit or explicit expectation that one may be called on to justify one's actions to others, which tends to motivate reflection on one's own decisions and behaviors" (Giessner, 2013). Demonstrating accountability creates an equal and fair opportunity for both teams to be rewarded for their good actions.

Many studies have been done and resulted in accountability helping the team develop leadership skills as well as an overall positive reaction from the team. "At its core, team accountability is about the sincere promises we make to ourselves and others, promises that underpin two critical aspects of teams: commitment and trust" (Compton 2007). Accountability can motivate and drive teams to victory. It can humble teams to the core and help them rebuild to maintain and develop their... foundations.





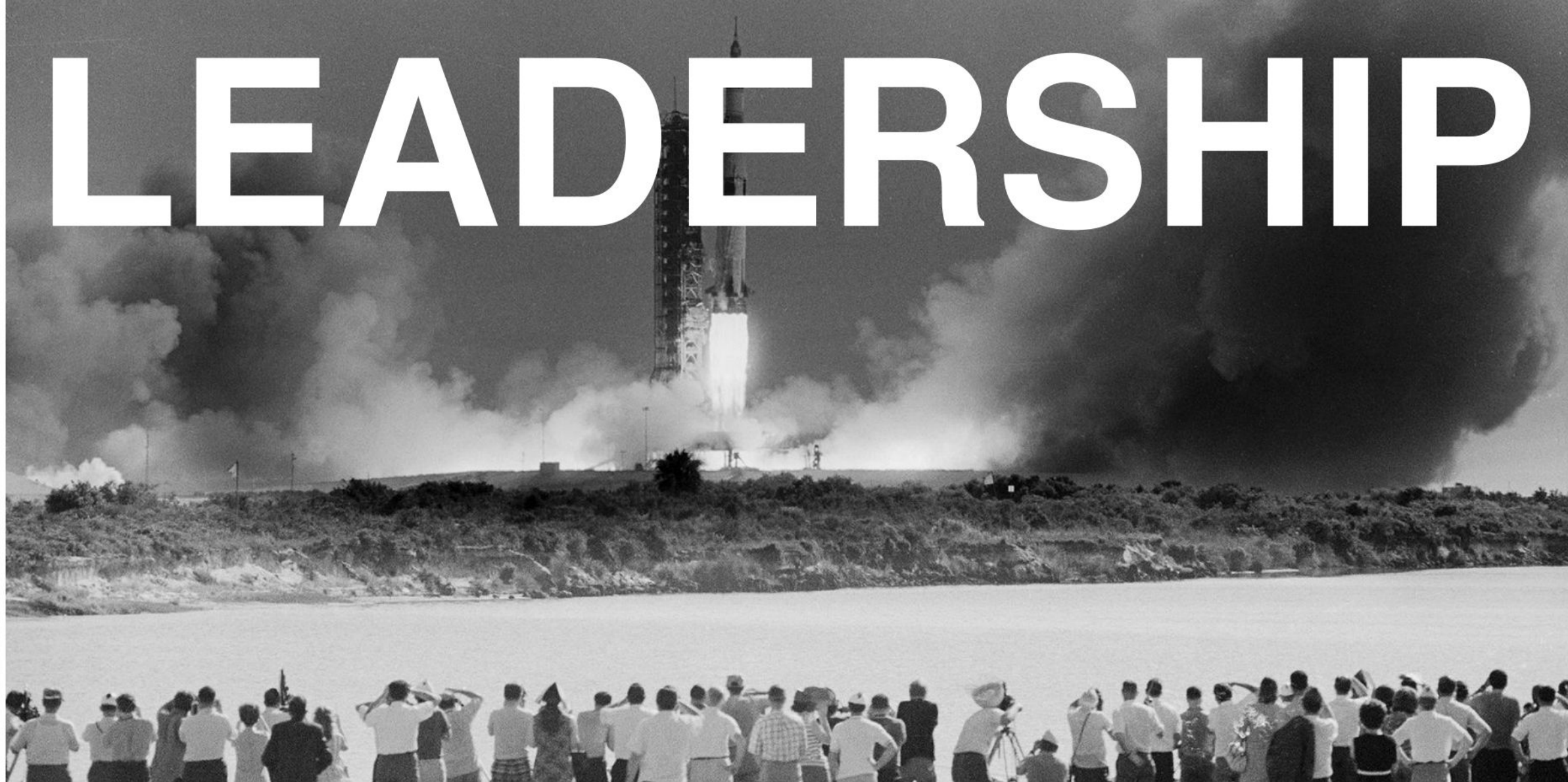


By holding yourself accountable it only allows for further growth and knowledge of the game and what organization that you take part in. By being accountable it allows you to become strong in decision making and learn from the mistakes which you have made. And when faced with hard decisions, you can look back and apply the lessons you learned from those mistakes. The ability to be accountable solidifies people into leaders and teams into legends

Leadership has been a part of society since the beginning of time. The world has always revolved around and will continue to revolve around the leaders of our respected societies. We define leadership as the ability to influence and motivate others to reach a specific goal. Each leader's mission is to create a vision followed by a path to achieve it. Without the vision that leadership provides, the world would slow down and ultimately become more unbalanced and chaotic.



LEADERSHIP





Rarely is a leader required to be in a position of power and authority in order to influence others. True leaders are able to maintain authority and power because they have a genuine audience that follows them. The true results of a good leader are not demonstrated only by the actions of the leader, but more so the actions of those who follow.

Inclusivity is a large part of the influence one possesses. The ability to welcome and give purpose to a person is no easy task and is many times the downfall of a once great leader. Flexibility and adaptation is another crucial and key part of leadership. Without the ability to adjust one's plans, a great plan can still fail. When a mountain of surprises is thrown at a leader, they must be quick to dodge, climb, or solve these problems. The ability to think quickly is something a leader can do when others cannot. Good leaders, along with quick adaptation abilities, must be open to learning and expanding at all times. They remain leaders because they are one step ahead of all those that follow, paving the way to success.



As we look at the team aspect of leadership, every team needs leaders. There is a wide variety of teams that fill many different roles and responsibilities in the world. All teams have goals, a vision, and something to work toward. The greatest teams of all time follow this principle of leadership, and they follow it extremely well.



COMMUNICATION





Communication is vital in our everyday lives. It is how we function as human beings. Being able to reason with one another through verbal or nonverbal wavelengths is an astounding accomplishment in and of itself, but to do so on a team adds a whole new level to it. No matter what team you find yourself on, there is a great deal of communication that is necessary for the success of the team. Communication brings unity and cohesiveness to a team. "The ability to communicate can make or break a team. Team members have to be able to share problems and solutions. They should also be able to communicate needs with one another" (University of the People, 2020). These principles build the foundation on which you can build yourself and others to become the powerhouse of a team you desire to be. In a family and specifically, between a married couple, it is highly important to maintain good levels of communication.

The growth and love of that marriage and family is highly dependent upon that communication. Many couples make the mistake of believing that their communicative skills that they have or had developed over the time of their courtship is sufficient and enough to get them through. Unfortunately, this is not the case. Researchers have found that an estimate of 40%-50% of first marriages will end up in divorce. The second marriage estimates usually end up with higher percentages. "Marital communication has been found to be the most frequent complaint in distressed marriages and is considered by marital therapists to be the most damaging relationship problem that couples experience. Furthermore, among couples planning marriage, measures of their communication prior to marriage predict their marital satisfaction 3 and 5 years after marriage" (Walsh, 1993). If communication between couples is lacking, it can lead to broken and failed marriages.

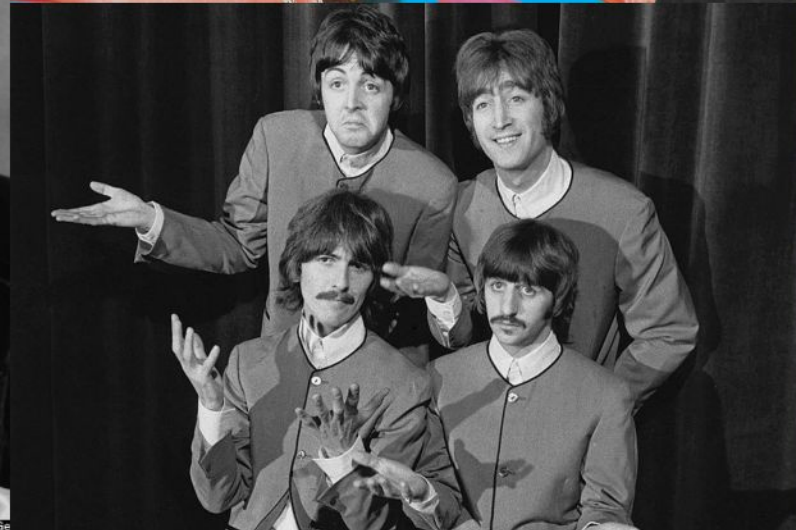




There are many reasons that someone would choose to file for divorce, but the most common reasons are things such as lack of commitment, young marriages, too much conflict and arguing, financial problems, and many more. Many of these reasons don't seem to be connected to communication at all, but they in fact do. Take for example, financial problems. Finance isn't just tracking numbers and obtaining the correct annual gross income. Being able to maintain a strong financial status as a married couple requires so much more communication. This requires both husband and wife to sit down and discuss the monthly budgets and fluctuating costs. When there is a lack of communication, trust can be lost. With no trust, communication fades, which can lead a couple down the road of problems and potentially divorce. Married couples with children also need to be on the same wavelength of communication. When couples communicate, they can raise a family in a strong healthy environment. Without that foundation of communication, families can crumble and fall apart.

CONSISTENCY





CONCLUSION

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